

Sterling Financial Services Corp

Human Resources Division | 1 World Trade Center, 85th Floor, New York, NY 10007

EMPLOYMENT CONTRACT

Contract Reference: SFSC-HR-2025-0312 | Confidential

EMPLOYER

Sterling Financial Services Corp

1 World Trade Center, 85th Floor
New York, NY 10007, United States
Represented by: Helen G. Park, SVP
Human Resources

EMPLOYEE

Christopher D. Owan

84 Riverside Drive, Apt. 6E
New York, NY 10024, United States
SSN: On file with HR

1. Position and Commencement

1.1 Sterling Financial Services Corp ("Employer") hereby employs Christopher D. Owan ("Employee") in the position of **Senior Investment Analyst**, effective **June 1, 2025** ("Commencement Date").

1.2 The Employee shall report to the Director of Equity Research and shall carry out such duties and responsibilities as are consistent with the position and as assigned from time to time.

1.3 The Employee's primary place of work shall be the Employer's offices at 1 World Trade Center, New York, NY 10007, subject to business travel requirements and any remote work policy in effect.

2. Compensation and Benefits

Component	Amount / Detail	Frequency
Base Salary	USD \$145,000	Annual (bi-weekly)
Performance Bonus (target)	20% of base salary	Annual (February)
Sign-On Bonus	USD \$15,000	One-time (upon start)
Health Insurance	Employer-sponsored (PPO/HMO)	Monthly

401(k) Matching	Up to 4% of base salary	Per pay period
Annual Leave	20 business days	Per year

2.1 The Employee's annual base salary shall be **USD \$145,000**, payable in equal bi-weekly installments, subject to applicable tax withholdings and deductions.

2.2 The Employee shall be eligible to participate in the Employer's annual discretionary bonus program, with a target of 20% of base salary, contingent on individual and company performance metrics as determined by management.

3. Term of Employment

This is a permanent employment agreement of indefinite duration, commencing on **June 1, 2025**. Either party may terminate this Agreement in accordance with Section 8 (Termination).

3.1 The Employee's employment is subject to a probationary period of ninety (90) days from the Commencement Date, during which either party may terminate with two (2) weeks' written notice.

4. Duties and Responsibilities

4.1 As Senior Investment Analyst, the Employee's primary duties shall include:

- Conducting fundamental research and financial analysis on equity securities
- Building and maintaining detailed financial models and valuation frameworks
- Preparing investment memoranda and presenting recommendations to the investment committee
- Monitoring portfolio holdings and tracking industry developments
- Mentoring junior analysts and contributing to team knowledge development

4.2 The Employee agrees to devote full working time and attention to the Employer's business and shall not undertake any secondary employment without prior written consent.

5. Confidentiality and Intellectual Property

5.1 The Employee acknowledges that in the course of employment, they will have access to Confidential Information of the Employer (including client data, investment strategies, and proprietary models). The Employee agrees to maintain such information in strict confidence during and after employment.

5.2 All work product created by the Employee in connection with their employment shall be deemed "work made for hire" and shall be the exclusive property of the Employer.

6. Non-Compete and Non-Solicitation

6.1 For a period of twelve (12) months following termination of employment, the Employee shall not directly compete with the Employer in the investment management sector within the State of New York.

6.2 For a period of eighteen (18) months following termination, the Employee shall not solicit any clients, employees, or contractors of the Employer.

7. Compliance

7.1 The Employee shall comply with all applicable securities laws and regulations, including SEC rules and FINRA requirements, and shall adhere to the Employer's Code of Ethics and Personal Trading Policy.

7.2 The Employee consents to background checks and securities industry registration as required by applicable regulations.

8. Termination

8.1 After the probationary period, the Employer may terminate this Agreement with sixty (60) days' written notice, or payment in lieu of notice.

8.2 The Employee may resign with thirty (30) days' written notice. The Employer may elect to place the Employee on garden leave during the notice period.

8.3 The Employer may terminate for Cause (as defined in the Employee Handbook) without notice or severance.

9. Governing Law

9.1 This Agreement shall be governed by the laws of the **State of New York**. Any disputes shall be resolved exclusively in the courts of New York County, New York.

AGREED AND ACCEPTED

By signing below, the parties confirm their acceptance of the terms of this Employment Contract.

Helen G. Park
SVP Human Resources
Sterling Financial Services Corp
Date: May 14, 2025

Christopher D. Owan
Employee
Date: May 14, 2025

Exhibit A — Compensation Summary

Element	Value (USD)	Notes
Annual Base Salary	\$145,000	Bi-weekly payroll
Target Annual Bonus	\$29,000 (20%)	Discretionary, performance-based
One-Time Sign-On Bonus	\$15,000	Payable on start date; clawback if left <12 months
Total Year-1 Target (cash)	\$189,000	Excluding equity and benefits

Exhibit B — Benefits Overview

- **Health Insurance:** Employer covers 90% of premium for employee and eligible dependents (Blue Cross Blue Shield PPO).
- **Dental & Vision:** Employer covers 80% of premium.
- **401(k):** Employer matches 100% of employee contributions up to 4% of base salary, vesting over 3 years.
- **Life Insurance:** 2x annual salary, employer-paid.
- **Paid Time Off:** 20 days annual leave, 10 federal holidays, 5 sick days.
- **Professional Development:** Up to \$3,000/year for approved courses, certifications, or conferences.
- **Commuter Benefits:** Pre-tax transit and parking benefit up to IRS limits.

Exhibit C — Acknowledgment of Policies

The Employee acknowledges receipt and understanding of the following Employer policies, which are incorporated by reference:

- Sterling Financial Services Corp Employee Handbook (2025 Edition)
- Code of Ethics and Personal Trading Policy
- Information Security and Acceptable Use Policy
- Anti-Harassment and Equal Opportunity Policy
- Remote Work and Hybrid Workplace Policy
- Data Privacy and Client Confidentiality Policy

Employee Confirmation: I, Christopher D. Owan, confirm that I have read and understood all policies listed above and agree to comply with them as a condition of my employment.

Christopher D. Owan

Employee Signature & Date